

Conclusion

This project successfully implemented an end-to-end machine learning workflow, including data preprocessing, exploratory data analysis, feature engineering, model development, and evaluation.

The analysis demonstrated that **Elo Rating, Recent Form, and Win Percentage are the most important factors influencing international football match outcomes**. These metrics consistently outperformed traditional ranking-based indicators and emerged as the strongest predictors within the model.

By combining these key performance indicators into a Team Strength framework, **Argentina emerged as the strongest overall team in the dataset**, supported by a high Elo Rating, strong recent form, and a consistently high win percentage.

Predicted FIFA World Cup 2026 Winner



Argentina

Based on the historical data analysis, team strength evaluation, and machine learning findings presented in this project, Argentina is identified as the most likely winner of the FIFA World Cup 2026.

Secondary Contender Analysis

While Argentina emerged as the strongest overall team based on the combined evaluation of Elo Rating, Recent Form, and Team Strength Score, the analysis also identified **Portugal** as a major contender for the FIFA World Cup 2026.

Key observations include:

- Portugal recorded one of the highest **Win Percentages** in the dataset.
- The team demonstrated strong consistency across international matches.
- Portugal's historical winning record indicates a high ability to convert performances into victories.
- The combination of experienced players and a strong competitive record makes Portugal a serious challenger for the title.

Therefore, although this project predicts **Argentina** as the most likely FIFA World Cup 2026 winner, **Portugal** should be considered the strongest alternative contender due to its exceptional win percentage and overall competitive performance.

Final Prediction



Predicted Winner: Argentina



Strongest Challenger: Portugal

Based on the machine learning analysis, team strength metrics, and historical performance indicators, Argentina emerges as the leading candidate for FIFA World Cup 2026. However, Portugal's outstanding win percentage suggests that it possesses the quality and consistency required to challenge for the trophy and potentially win the tournament if current performance trends continue.

Note: Football outcomes are inherently uncertain, and actual tournament results may differ due to injuries, squad selection, tactical decisions, and other factors beyond the scope of this model.